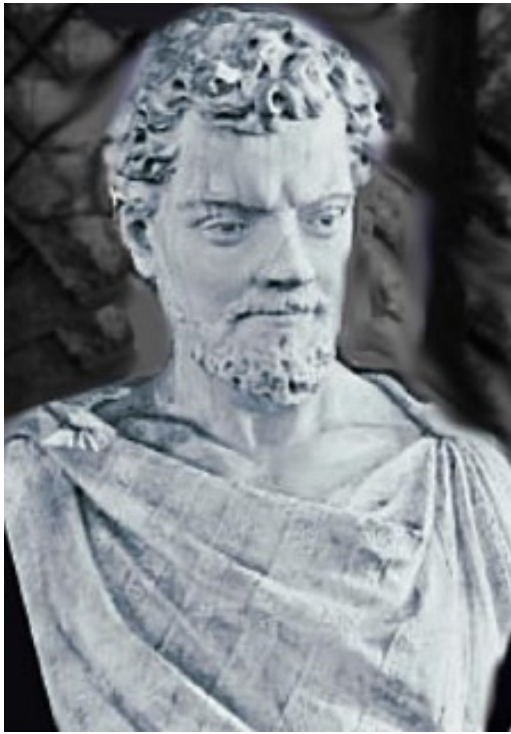








Here's the first:

Lucretius, a Roman philosopher who lived in the first century B.C., was part of this tradition. In his poem *De Rerum Natura* (*On the Nature of Things*), he gave two short and intriguing arguments against the idea that death is at all a bad thing.

“If it happens that people are to suffer unhappiness and pain in the future, they themselves must exist at that future time for harm to be able to befall them. Since death takes away this possibility by preventing the existence of those who might have been visited by troubles, you may be sure that there is nothing to fear in death. Those who no longer exist cannot become miserable, and it makes not one speck of difference whether or not they have ever been born once their mortal life has been snatched away by deathless death.”

death is at all a bad thing.

*Rein Natura (On the Nature of Things), he gave two*

century B.C., was part of this tradition. In his poem De



short and intriguing arguments against the idea that

Lucretius, a Roman philosopher who lived in the first



“If it happens that people are to suffer unhappiness and pain in the future, they themselves must exist at that future time for harm to be able to befall them. Since death takes away this possibility by preventing the existence of those who might have been visited by troubles, you may be sure that there is nothing to fear in death. Those who no longer exist cannot become miserable, and it makes not one speck of difference whether or not they have ever been born once their mortal life has been snatched away by deathless death.”